SKULBASE USER GUIDE

Academic leadership guide

For principals, deputy principals, directors of studies, heads of department, timetablers and exams officers

Running the academic side of the school: choosing the exam each class is marking and following the marking, the calendar, the timetable and lesson cover, the exam paper bank from moderation to release, professional records and syllabus coverage, CBC assessment, and approvals.

Contents

1. Getting started
   - Who this guide is for
   - Activate your account with an invite code
   - Sign in
   - Finding your way around
2. The school at a glance
   - Across the school
3. Running exams and marking
   - Choose the exam being marked
   - See who is behind on marking
   - Lock a finished term
4. The academic calendar
   - The school calendar
5. Building the timetable
   - School day
   - Subjects & hours
   - Teachers
   - Labs & rooms (optional)
   - Generate & publish
   - Arrange lesson cover
6. The exam paper bank
   - Moderate papers (HOD, DOS)
   - Print, pack and release (Exams Officer)
   - How teachers submit papers
7. Professional records and coverage
   - Review schemes of work
   - Syllabus coverage
   - CBC assessment
8. Approvals
   - Approve staff leave
   - Approve expenses
   - Report a discipline incident
9. Getting help
   - Where to get help

CHAPTER 1

Getting started

Leaders sign in with their own account like everyone else. The administrator then assigns the duty under Settings → Roles & duties, and its pages appear in the menu the next time you open Skulbase. You only see a page if your school has switched its module on and your role or duty uses it. If something here is missing from your menu, ask your administrator.

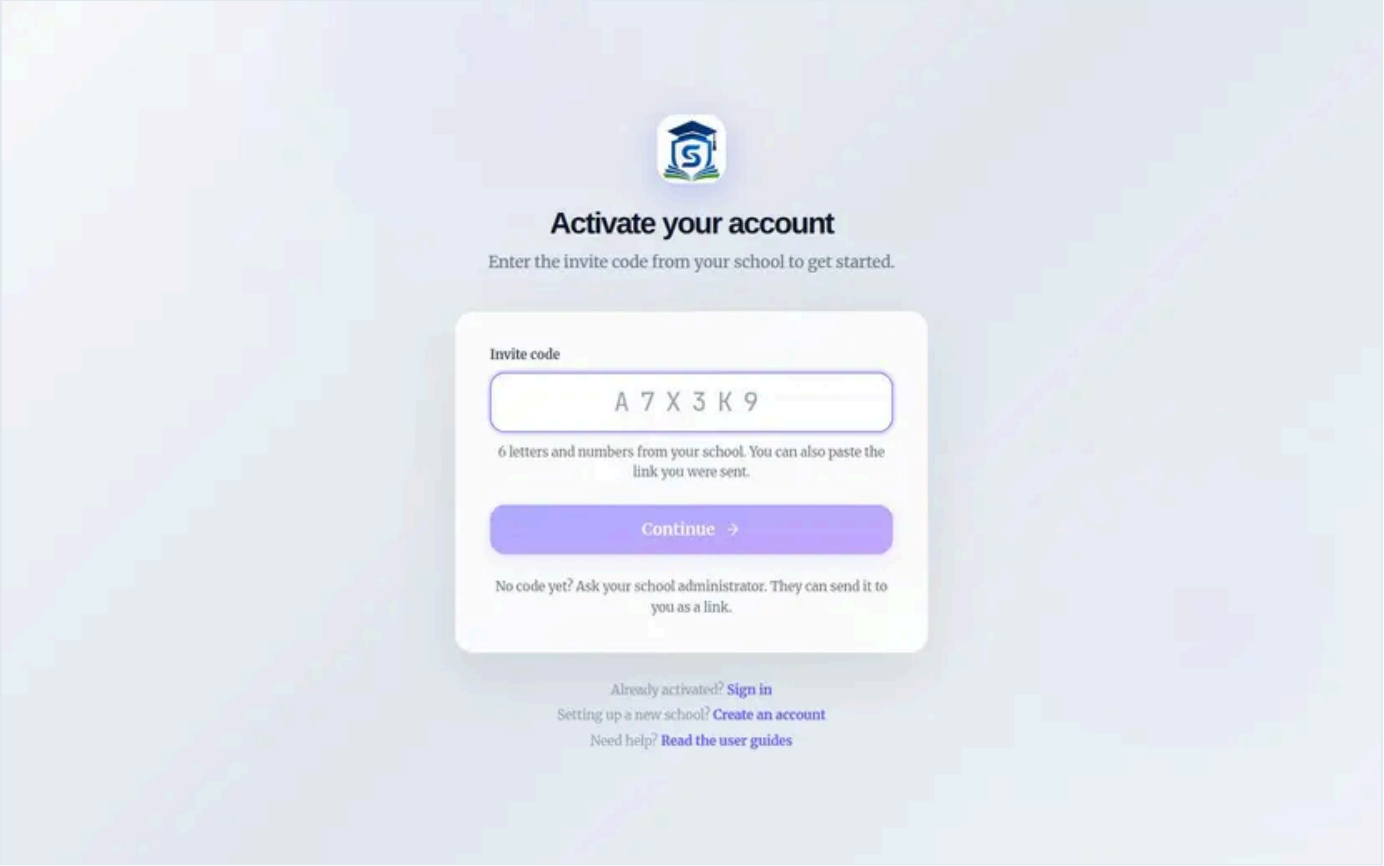
1.1 Who this guide is for

The duties this guide covers, and what each one can do.

- Principal / Head teacher: every module page and approval. Setting up classes, users and settings stays with Admin accounts.
- Deputy Principal: the exam being marked, calendar, papers, timetable, professional records, CBC and discipline; sees boarding and health; approves leave and expenses.
- Director of Studies (DOS): exams and which one is being marked, the paper bank, the timetable, professional records and the academic calendar.
- Head of Department (HOD): moderates exam papers and reviews schemes of work and coverage.
- Timetabler: builds and publishes the timetable and arranges lesson cover.
- Exams Officer: runs the paper bank (printing, packing and release) and chooses the exam being marked.

1.2 Activate your account with an invite code

Teachers, staff and learners do not sign up on their own. Your school adds you, and you get a personal invite code (or a link that has the code in it) to set up your login.



Activating an account: type the invite code from your school, or open the link they sent you.

1. **Get your code**
   Your school administrator gives you a six-character invite code, for example A7X3K9, by SMS, WhatsApp, on paper, or as a link. The code only works for your account.

2. **Open the activation page**
   Tap the link you were sent, or go to skulbase.com, choose Sign in and then “Activate your account”. If you opened a link, the code is already filled in.

3. **Check it is you**
   Press Continue. Skulbase shows the name the school registered. If it is not you, choose “Not you?” and ask the school for the right code.

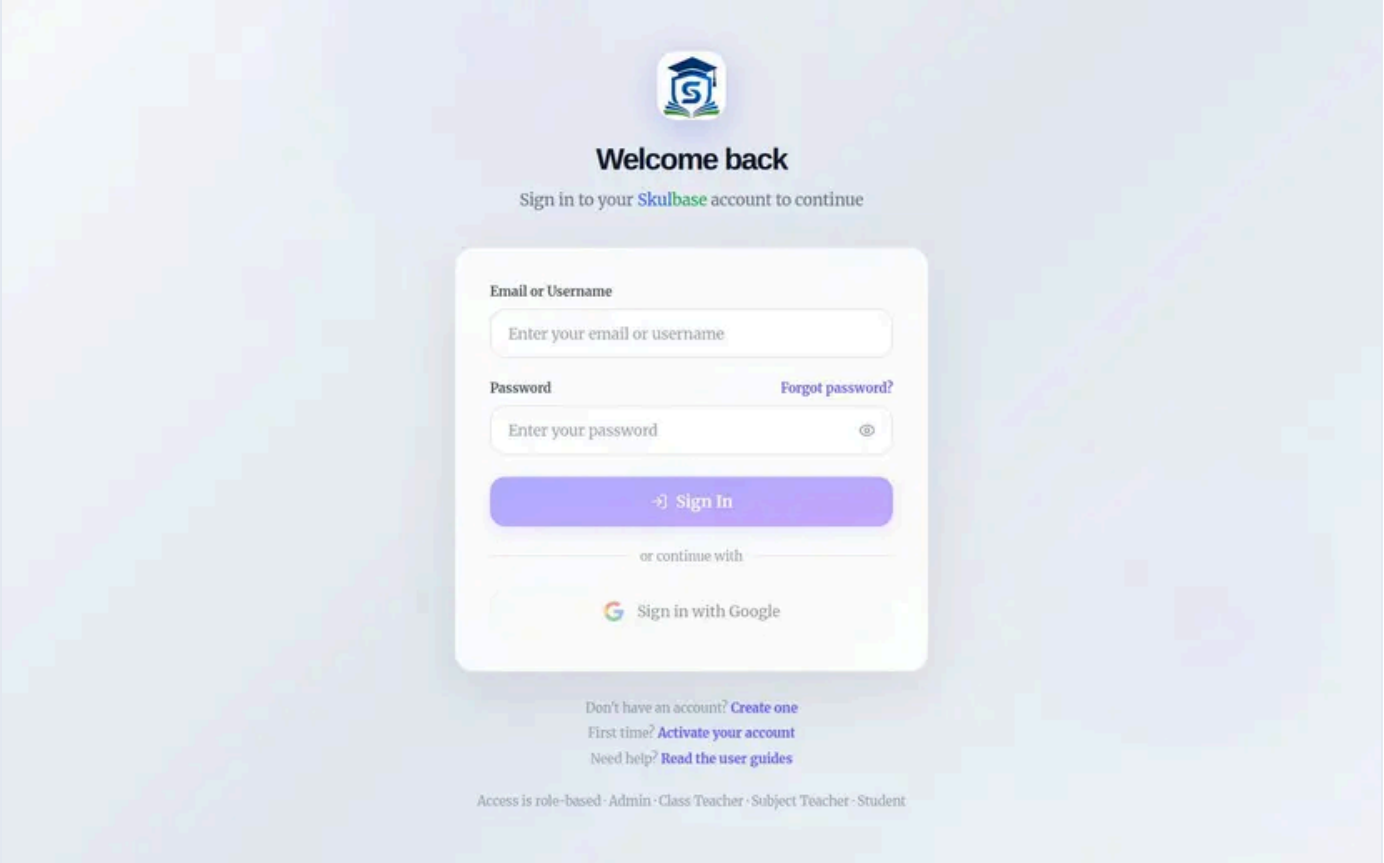
4. **Choose how you will sign in**
   Pick a username (one is suggested for you) and a password of at least 8 characters, or continue with Google. Adding an email address lets you reset your password yourself later.

5. **You are in**
   You are signed in straight away and land on the home page for your role.

⚠ **Good to know:** Each code can be used once. If yours says it has expired or was already used, ask your administrator to reset your account; they get a fresh code in seconds.

1.3 Sign in

Once your account is active, sign in with your email address or username and your password, or with Google if you activated with Google.



The sign-in page. “Forgot password?” sends you a code by email.

1. **Go to the sign-in page**
   Open skulbase.com and choose Sign in.

2. **Enter your details**
   Type your email address or username, then your password, and press Sign In. Or press “Sign in with Google”.

3. **Forgot your password?**
   Choose “Forgot password?”, enter your email address, and type the six-digit code we email you along with a new password. This also works if you have only ever used Google, and afterwards both ways work.

> **Tip:** Save skulbase.com to your phone’s home screen. It opens like an app and remembers you are signed in.

1.4 Finding your way around

The menu only shows the pages your role can use. On a computer it runs down the left-hand side; on a phone the main pages sit in a bar along the bottom.

- On a computer, the arrow at the top of the menu makes it narrower (icons only) or wider (icons and names). Skulbase remembers your choice.
- Press the / key, or tap “Search menu”, to jump to any page by typing part of its name.
- Your name at the bottom of the menu opens your account menu: switch between light and dark appearance, or sign out.
- If you hold more than one role (for example an administrator who is also a class teacher), use “View as” in the account menu to switch views.
- On a phone, the bottom bar shows your four most-used pages. Everything else is under More.

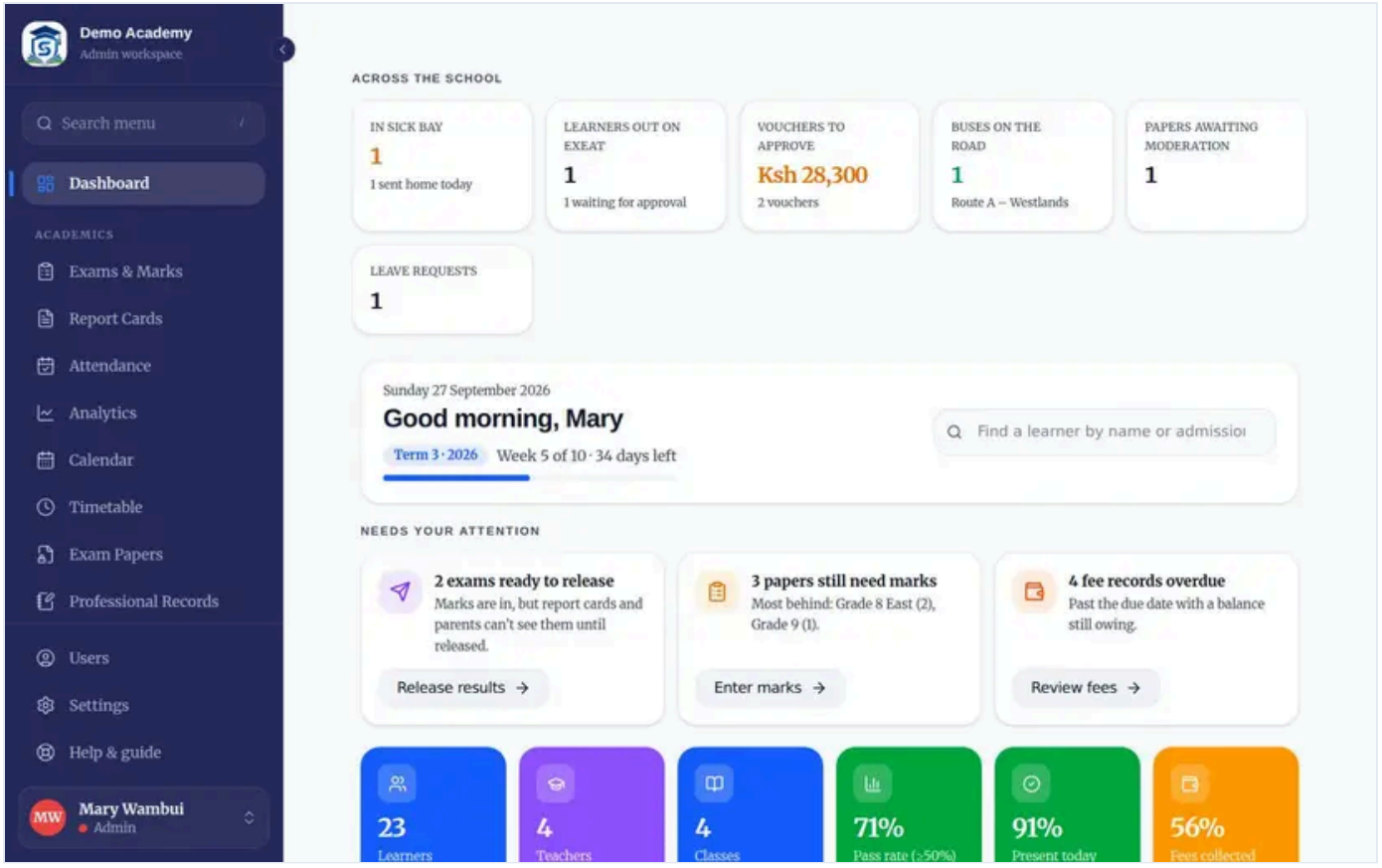
CHAPTER 2

The school at a glance

The principal and deputy see live figures from every module the school runs at the top of the dashboard.

2.1 Across the school

“Across the school” shows one tile per thing that needs a leader’s eye: learners in the sick bay, learners out on exeat, vouchers waiting for approval, buses on the road, papers awaiting moderation and leave requests. Tap a tile to open its page.



The dashboard with “Across the school” tiles above the usual academic figures.

CHAPTER 3

Running exams and marking

The Principal, Deputy Principal, DOS and Exams Officer decide which exam each class is marking, follow the marking until every sheet is in, and lock the term once report cards are out. All of it is on Exams & Marks → Enter & Correct Marks. How teachers enter and release marks is in the teacher guides.

3.1 Choose the exam being marked

"Exam being marked" on Enter & Correct Marks decides which exam each class is marking. Teachers then go straight to it, so Mid-Term marks never land in End-Term. Administrators, and staff with the Principal, Deputy Principal, DOS or Exams Officer duty, see it.

1. **Pick each level's exam**
   Each level (for example Junior School) has a card. Choose the exam it is sitting, and every class in the level moves to it. A class sitting something different, such as a Form 4 mock, can be set on its own.
2. **Set the exam dates**
   Under a level's "Exam dates", pick the day each exam starts. Every paper of that exam for the level's classes moves to that date, so Skulbase knows which exam is due.
3. **Move on when it changes**
   Once an exam is over, the card offers "Mid-Term done? Move on to End-Term". Earlier exams stay open for corrections. "Stop marking" closes a level's exam.
4. **Answer requests**
   When a teacher presses "Ask for the exam", their class shows "Asked by" with their name until you choose one.

- The heading says how many classes still have no exam chosen. Teachers there pick an exam themselves until you choose one.
- CATs and topical tests are always open; teachers reach them from "Mark a CAT, correct an earlier exam or open another term".

3.2 See who is behind on marking

"Marking progress" on Enter & Correct Marks lists, for the exam each class is marking, every subject in every stream as marks entered out of expected, with the teacher assigned. Unfinished sheets come first, so you can nudge the right teacher before report-card day. Tap a cell to open that mark sheet.

3.3 Lock a finished term

Once report cards are out, lock the term so nobody changes a mark by mistake. The lock card is on Enter & Correct Marks for those who choose the exam being marked.

1. **Lock it**
   Press “Lock term” on the card and confirm. Nobody can enter, change or remove a mark in that term until it is unlocked. Releasing results still works.
2. **Unlock for a correction**
   Press Unlock, let the teacher fix the mark, then lock the term again.

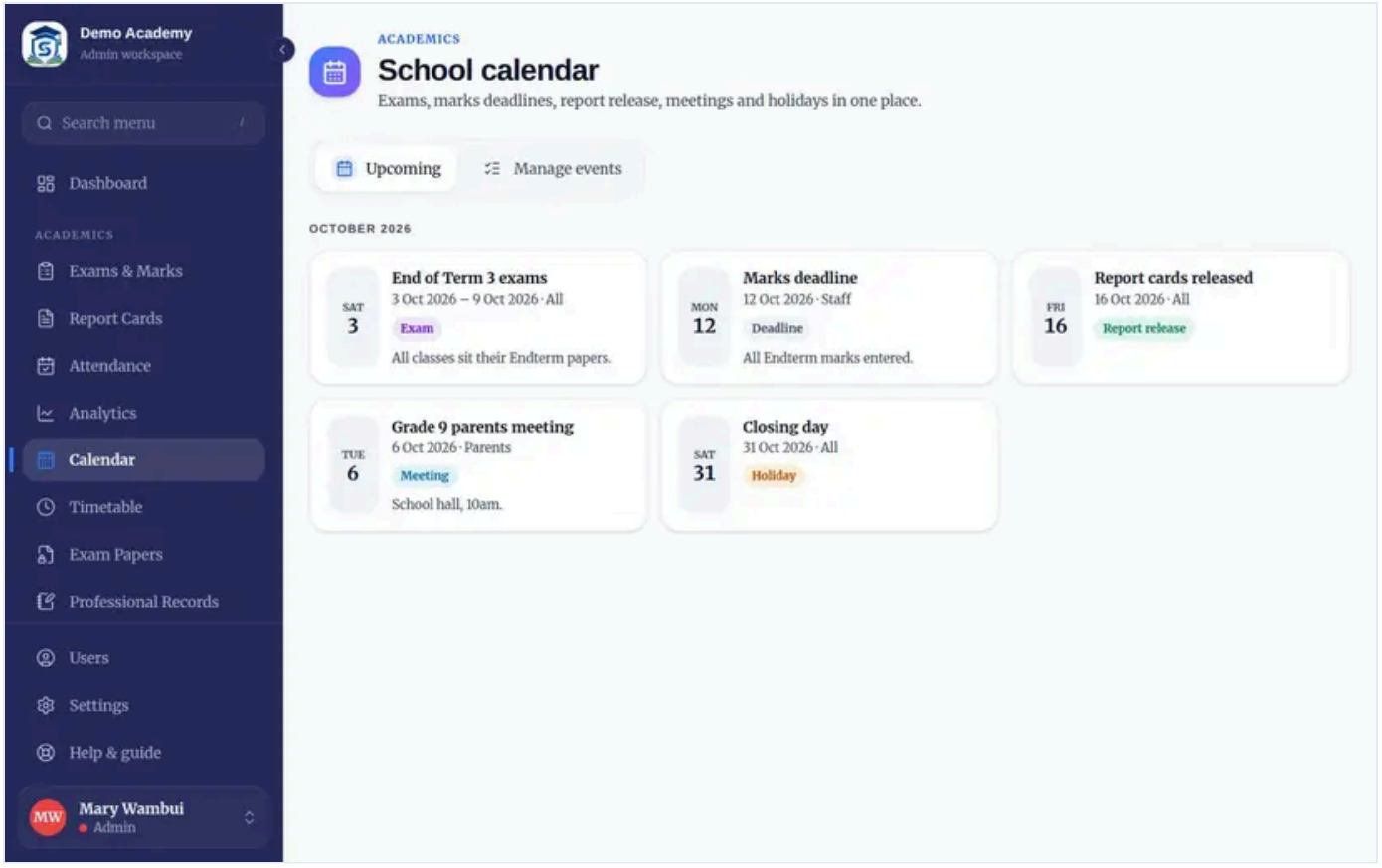
CHAPTER 4

The academic calendar

Put every exam window, marks deadline and report release on the calendar, so teachers, learners and parents all work to the same dates.

4.1 The school calendar

Calendar lists what is coming up across the school: exam windows, marks deadlines, report-card release dates, meetings and holidays. Everyone can read it; the DOS, deputy and principal add events.



Calendar → Upcoming: each event shows its date, who it is for and its type.

1. **Open Manage events**
   On Calendar, open the “Manage events” tab and press Add.

2. **Describe the event**
   Give it a title, choose its type (exam, deadline, report release, meeting, holiday or other), the start date and, for several days, the end date.

3. **Choose who sees it**
   Everyone, staff only, learners or parents. Parents see events meant for everyone or for parents in their portal.

4 **Link an exam (optional)**

Link the event to an exam so the dates stay together.

- Events are marked by type (exam, deadline, report release, meeting, holiday) and by who they are for: everyone, staff, learners or parents.
- Parents and learners only see events meant for them.
- To add an event (if you are allowed), open “Manage events”, press Add, and fill in the title, type, dates, who sees it and any details. An event can be linked to an exam.

CHAPTER 5

Building the timetable

Timetable → "Set up & generate" takes you through five steps in the order a timetable is made. It checks each class's lessons a week against the Ministry (KICD) figures, never books a teacher or room twice, keeps teachers free at the times they are away, and spreads each subject across the week. Anything that stops you generating is listed at the top, each with a "Fix it" button that opens the step where it is fixed.

5.1 School day

Choose the school days, then set each period and break with its times. Change a time and every later period moves with it. "Move day" starts the whole day earlier or later, "Lessons of … min" changes every lesson's length, and "Quick setup" builds a day from when it starts, how long lessons are, how many there are and where the breaks fall.

- Untick a day on a period to run it only on some days: a ninth lesson on Friday, or games on Wednesday afternoon. The week then counts each day's own lessons.
- A level with a different day (30-minute lessons for Grades 1–3, Junior School starting later) gets its own bell under "Levels with their own bell". A teacher who teaches on both bells is still never booked twice.
- Nothing changes until you press "Save school day"; "Discard" puts the saved day back.

⚠ **Good to know:** If you change the day after publishing, generate the timetable again so lessons follow the new times.

5.2 Subjects & hours

Every class with its subjects, teachers and lessons a week. A tick means a subject has the Ministry's lessons a week for that level; where yours differs, the Ministry's figure is shown beside it ("KICD 7"). The bar shows how full the class's week is.

1. **Start from who teaches what**
   "Import" creates a load for every subject each teacher is assigned to a class this year, at the Ministry's lessons a week. "Match the Ministry" sets every subject back to the Ministry's figure, doubles included.

2. **Check the elective groups**
   When a class has more subjects than periods, its electives run in groups taught at the same time, worked out from learners' recorded choices so nobody has two subjects in one group. Grade 10 uses the school's offered combinations until choices are recorded.

3. **Fix a class that does not fit**
   A class with more lessons than its week shows ready-made fixes: make the day longer for its level (recommended: every other class keeps its day and no lessons are cut), run its electives in fewer groups (it lists who would have to change a subject), or teach fewer lessons a week. Pick one and press “Use this”.

4. **Say when subjects are best taught**
   Mathematics and sciences go before lunch and PE and the arts later unless you choose otherwise. Choose Morning, Afternoon or Any time for any subject; it applies to that subject at every level.

> **Tip:** To change one load (its teacher, lessons a week, doubles or the room it needs), open “Edit teaching loads one by one”.

5.3 Teachers

Each teacher’s whole week across every class and level they teach, against the periods they can teach. Add the times a teacher cannot teach (a part-time teacher, a BOM teacher shared with another school, a deputy’s admin morning): the timetable keeps them free then, and a move or a cover that would book them is refused.

- “Time away” takes a day and the whole day, the morning, the afternoon or set times.
- A teacher with more lessons than periods stops generating: give some of their classes to another teacher, or free some of their time.
- “Most lessons in a row” is the longest run one teacher teaches without a break.

5.4 Labs & rooms (optional)

Add labs, the computer room or the hall only if some lessons need them, and set “Needs a room type” on those loads. Every other lesson stays in the class’s own room, and no room is ever booked twice.

5.5 Generate & publish

When the top of the studio says Ready, press “Generate timetable”. In about 15 seconds you get a draft that has been checked lesson by lesson: every subject has its lessons a week, and no teacher or room is booked twice, across every class and bell.

1. **Fill free periods**
   "Fill free periods with extra lessons" is on unless you turn it off. A class with fewer lessons than its week (40 lessons in 45 periods, say) gets extra lessons of its own subjects in those periods, mathematics, languages and sciences first, and a shorter elective takes every period of its option block. Only where the teacher and any room are free, so nobody is booked twice; each teacher takes at most a few extras a week and never more lessons in a row than you allow. The checks say how many periods, if any, were left free and in which classes.

2. **Read the score**
   The score says how well the week is spread: each subject on different days, mathematics and sciences in the morning, no long runs for teachers and no free periods in the middle of a class's day, with what could still be better. "Reshuffle" makes another draft and keeps your pinned lessons; keep the better one.

3. **Adjust by hand**
   Pick a class, then click a lesson. Green slots are free to move into, blue ones swap with the lesson there, and faded ones are not possible (point at one to see why, for example the teacher is teaching another class then). "Pin here" keeps a lesson in its slot when you reshuffle.

4. **Publish**
   Press Publish and give the timetable the name teachers and learners will see, such as "Term 1 2027 timetable". It replaces the one they see now under Timetable, and learners' My timetable.

> **Tip:** "Lessons a week, subject by subject" lists every class's subjects with the lessons placed against the lessons needed, and any extra lessons as +1, +2.

5.6 Arrange lesson cover

When a teacher is away, open "Lesson cover", choose the date and the absent teacher. Their lessons that day are listed with the colleagues who are free at that time; pick one to cover each lesson. Colleagues recorded as away then are not offered.

> **Tip:** Leave requests list the lessons and duties that need cover, so check approved leave first.

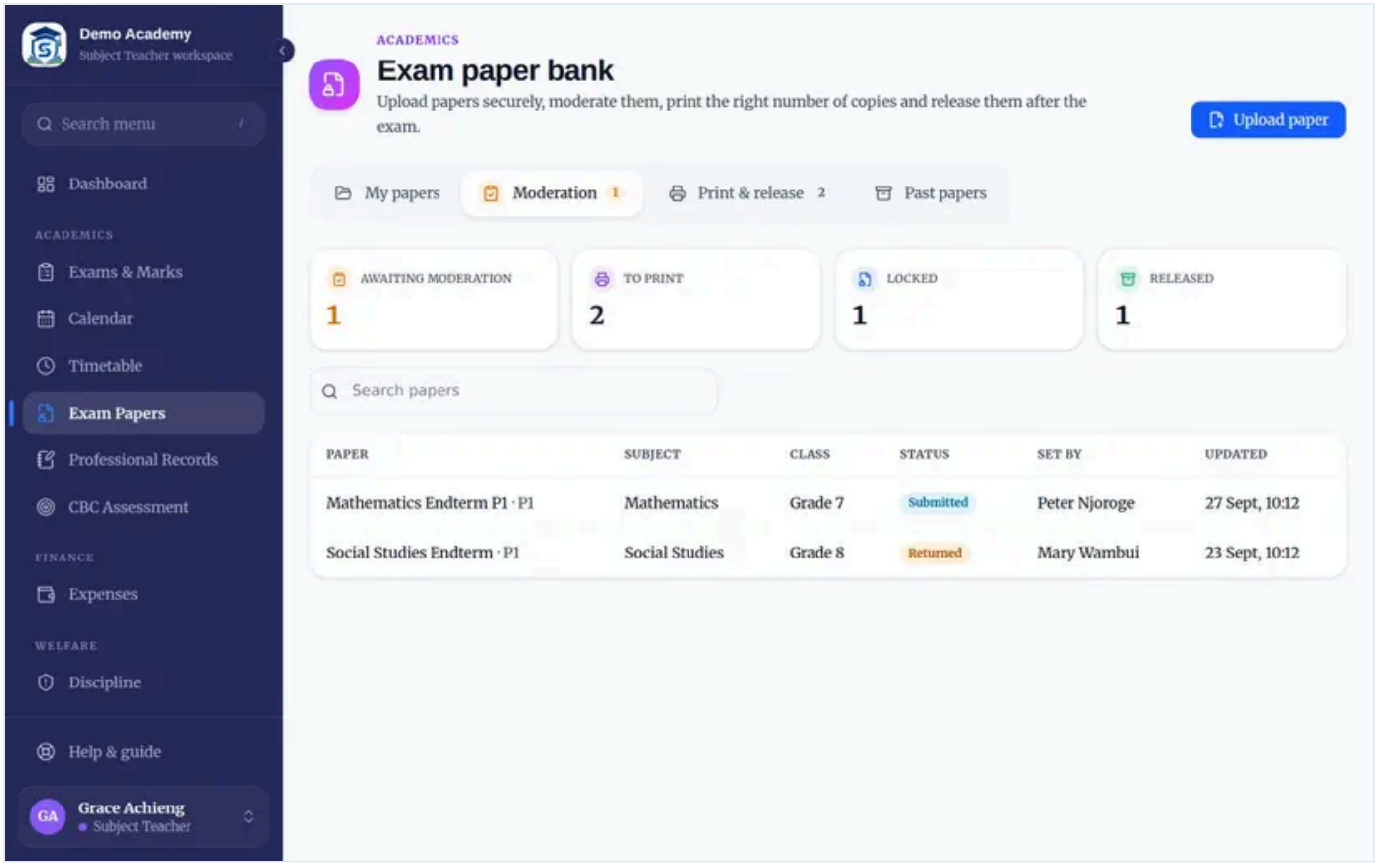
CHAPTER 6

The exam paper bank

Papers move through moderation, printing and release in one place, with every download stamped and logged.

6.1 Moderate papers (HOD, DOS)

The Moderation tab lists papers teachers have submitted. Open one to read the paper and marking scheme.



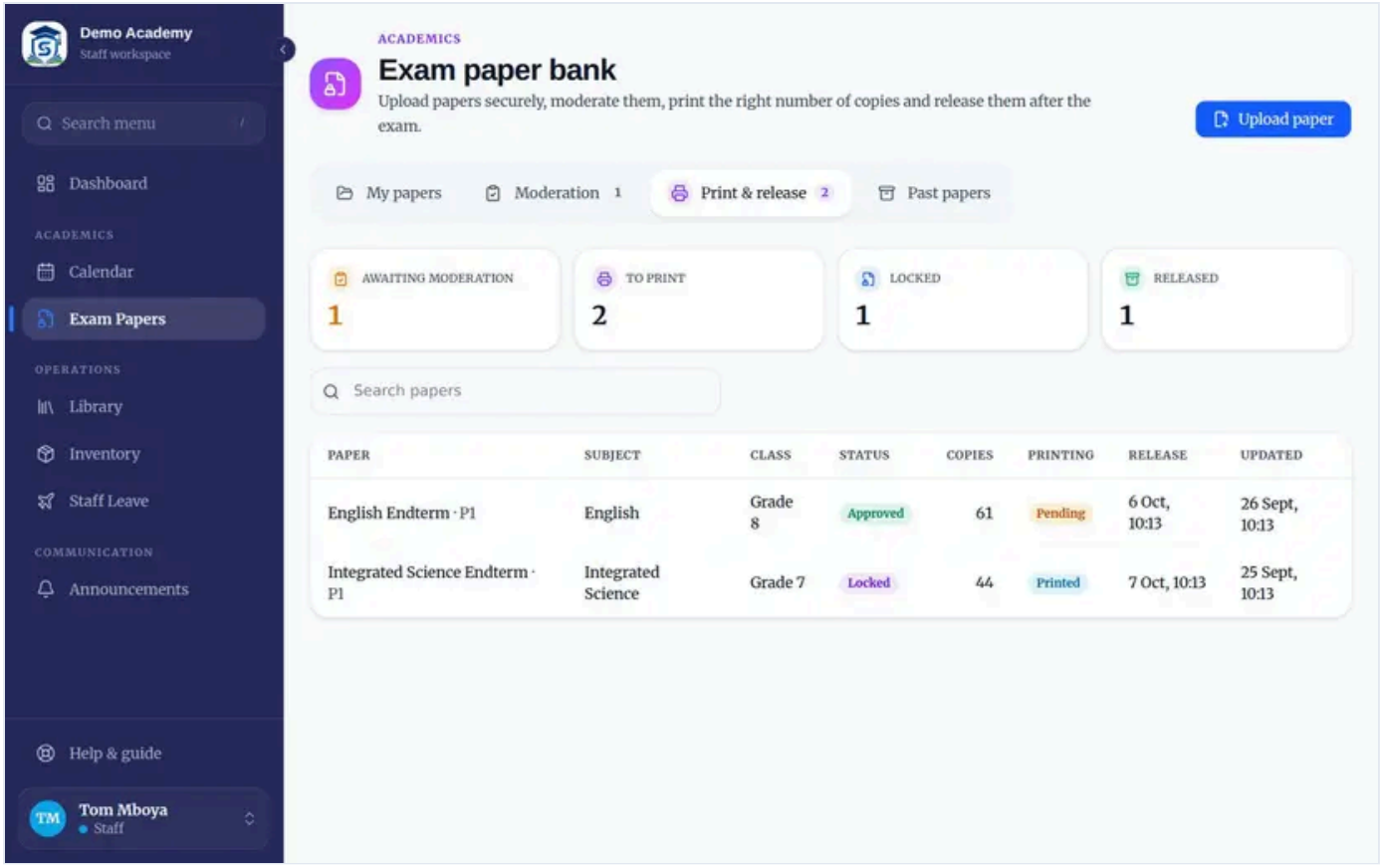
Exam papers → Moderation: papers waiting for you, with totals for each stage.

1. **Open the paper**
   Tap it, then “Open paper” and “Marking scheme”. Files open stamped with your name and the time.

2. **Approve or return**
   Approve it, or return it with a comment saying what to change (a comment is required when returning). The teacher sees the comment in the paper’s History.

6.2 Print, pack and release (Exams Officer)

The “Print & release” tab lists approved papers with the number of copies each class needs. Approved papers are locked so nobody can change them.

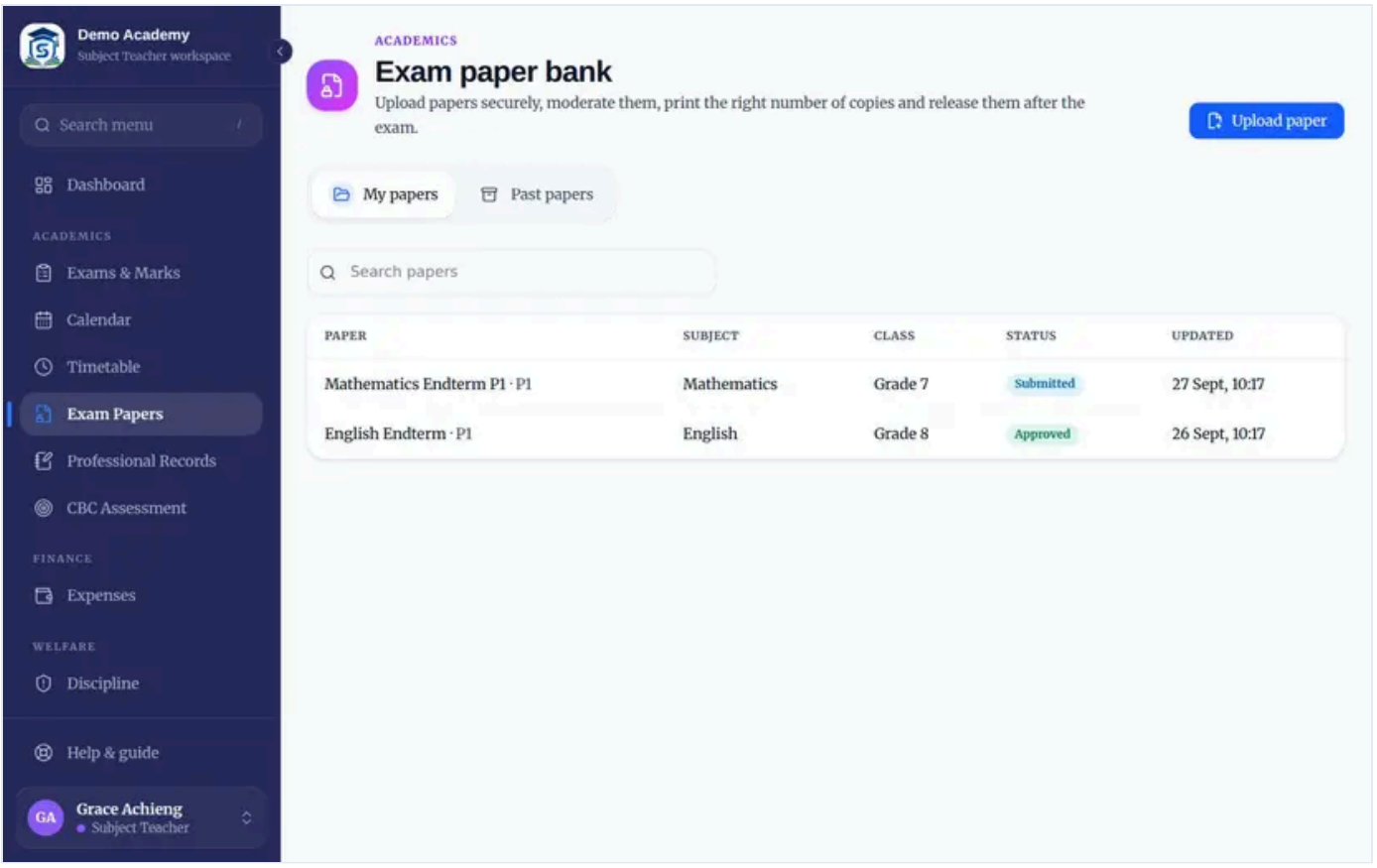


Print & release: mark each paper Printed, then Packed, and release it after the exam.

- Mark a paper Printed when the copies are done and Packed when they are sealed for the exam room.
- After the exam (at the release time set by the teacher) release it; it then appears under Past papers for revision.

6.3 How teachers submit papers

The Exam paper bank keeps exam papers safe until the exam. You upload your paper, your head of department moderates it, the exams office prints it, and it is released after the exam.



Exam papers → My papers: every paper you set and where it is in moderation.

1. **Upload**
   Press “Upload paper”. Give it a title (for example “End of Term 2 Mathematics”), choose the subject, class level and term, the paper label (P1, P2), how many copies are needed, and when it may be released after the exam. Attach the paper (PDF or Word) and, ideally, the marking scheme.

2. **Submit it**
   Open the paper and submit it for moderation. Its status changes from Draft to Submitted.

3. **Act on comments**
   If it comes back Returned, read the moderator’s comment in its History, replace the files and submit again. Once Approved it is locked for printing.

- Papers open stamped with the viewer’s name and the time, and every download is logged, so leaks can be traced.
- Past papers are available once released, for revision.

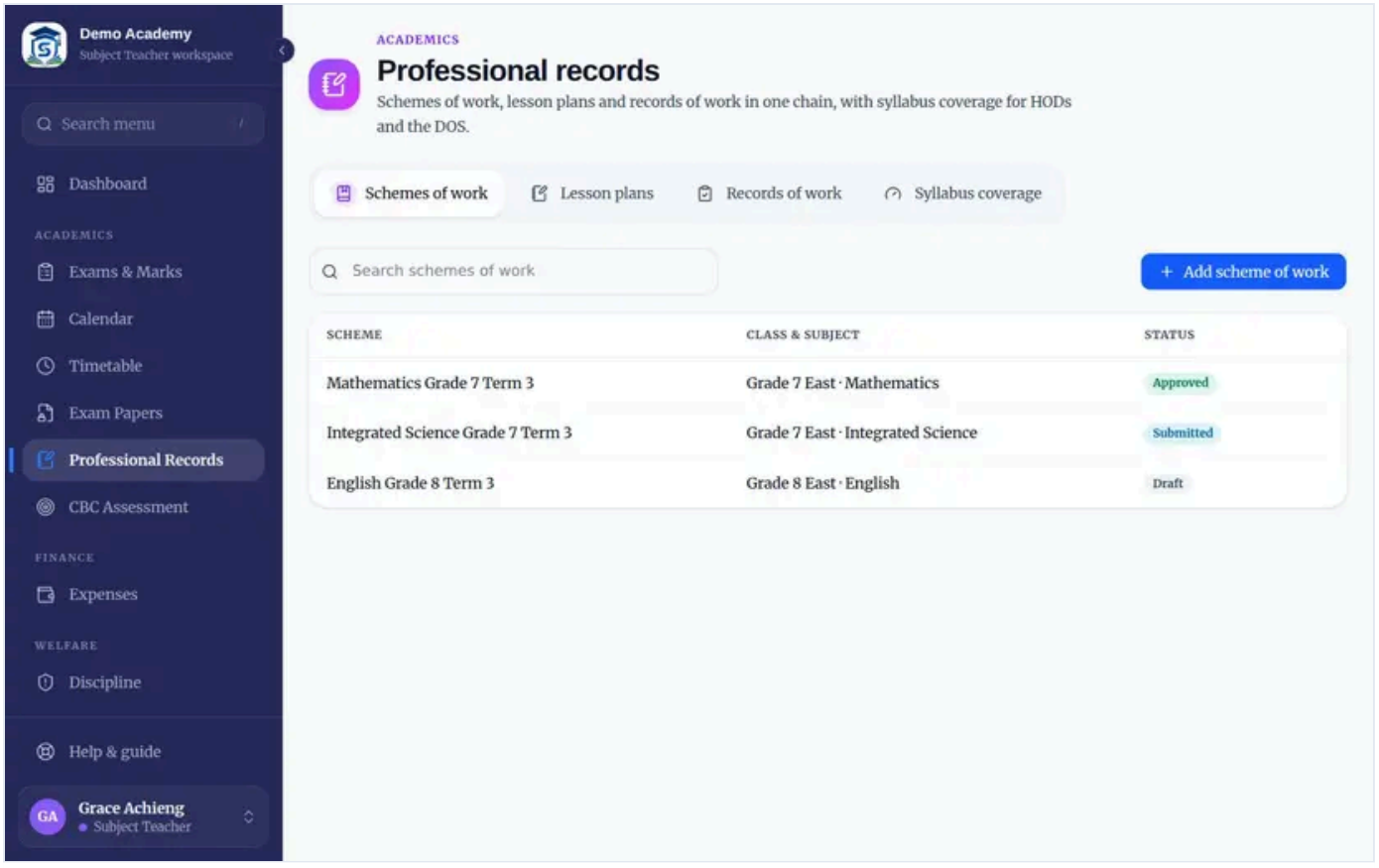
CHAPTER 7

Professional records and coverage

Heads of department and the DOS review schemes of work and follow syllabus coverage class by class.

7.1 Review schemes of work

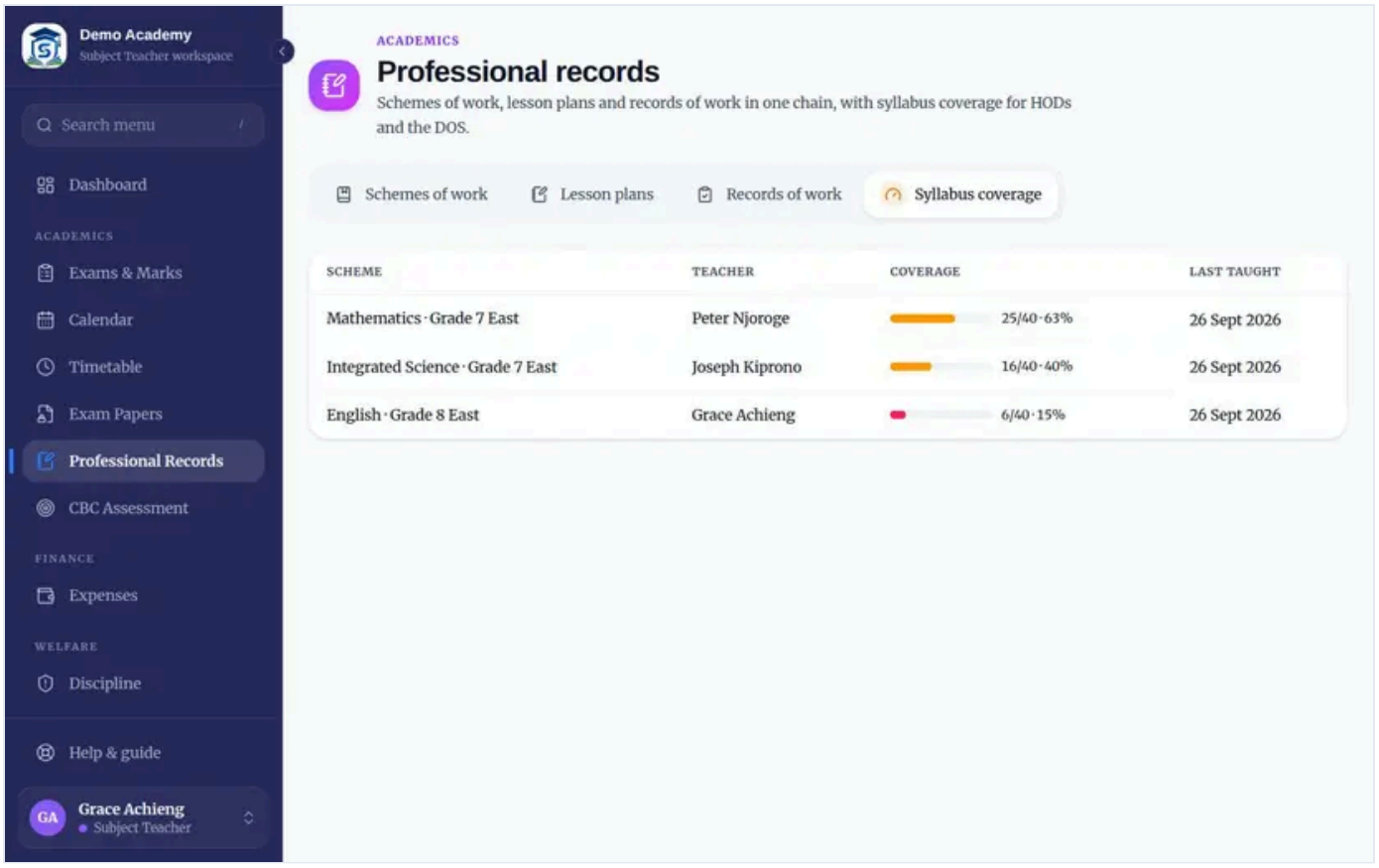
Submitted schemes show “Submitted” on the Schemes of work tab. Open one, read it, and approve it or return it with a review comment.



Schemes of work: Draft, Submitted, Approved or Returned.

7.2 Syllabus coverage

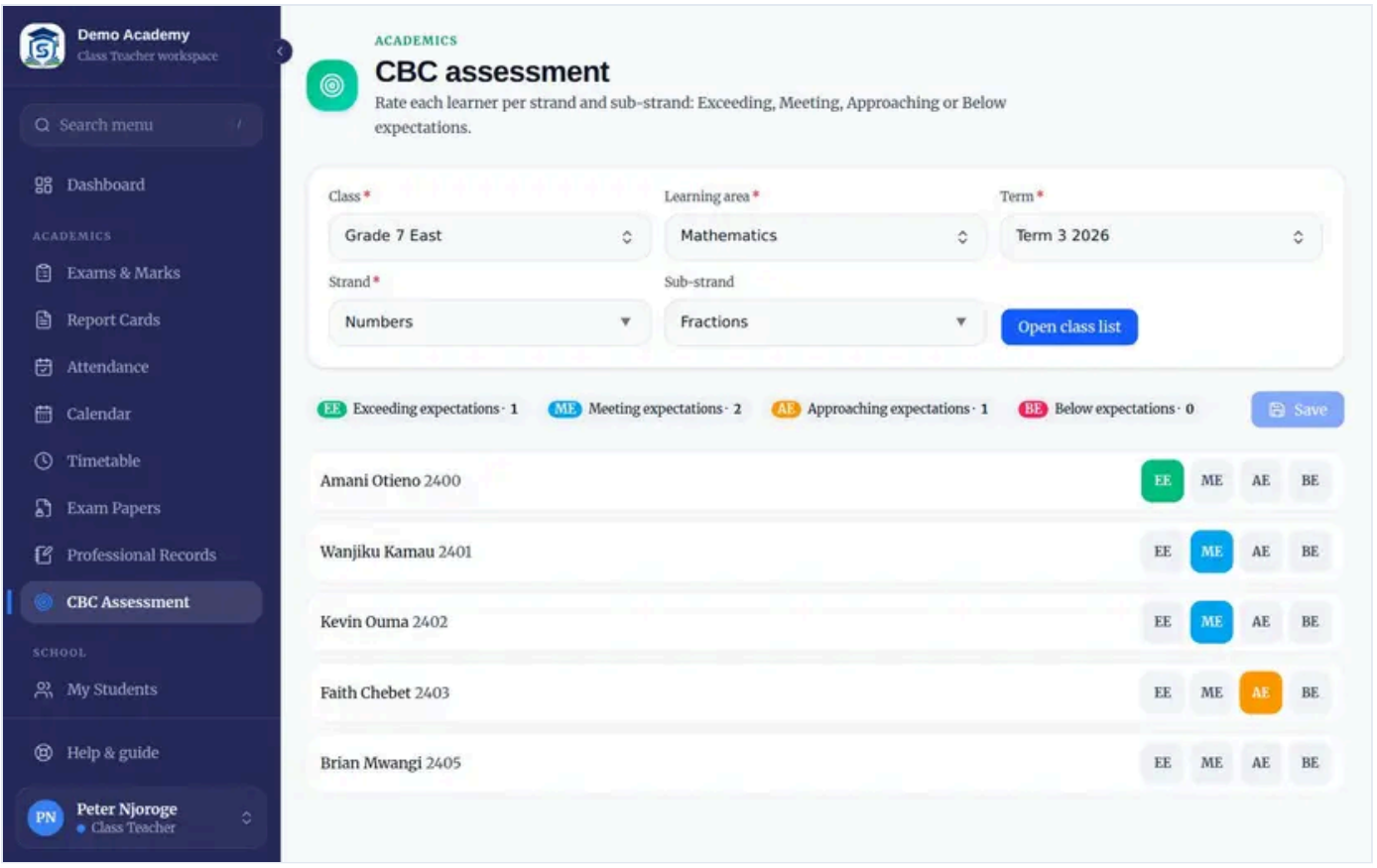
The Syllabus coverage tab shows, for each scheme, how many planned lessons have been taught, as a percentage, and when the class was last taught.



Syllabus coverage: spot classes falling behind early.

7.3 CBC assessment

CBC Assessment records each learner's level for a strand and sub-strand: Exceeding (EE), Meeting (ME), Approaching (AE) or Below (BE) expectations.



CBC assessment: pick the class, learning area, term and strand, then rate each learner.

1. **Choose what you are assessing**
   Pick the class, the learning area, the term, and the strand (for example Numbers) and sub-strand (for example Fractions).

2. **Open the class list**
   Press “Open class list”. Every learner in the class is listed.

3. **Rate each learner**
   Tap EE, ME, AE or BE on each row and add a comment if you like. The totals at the top update as you go.

4. **Save**
   Press Save. You can come back and change a rating later.

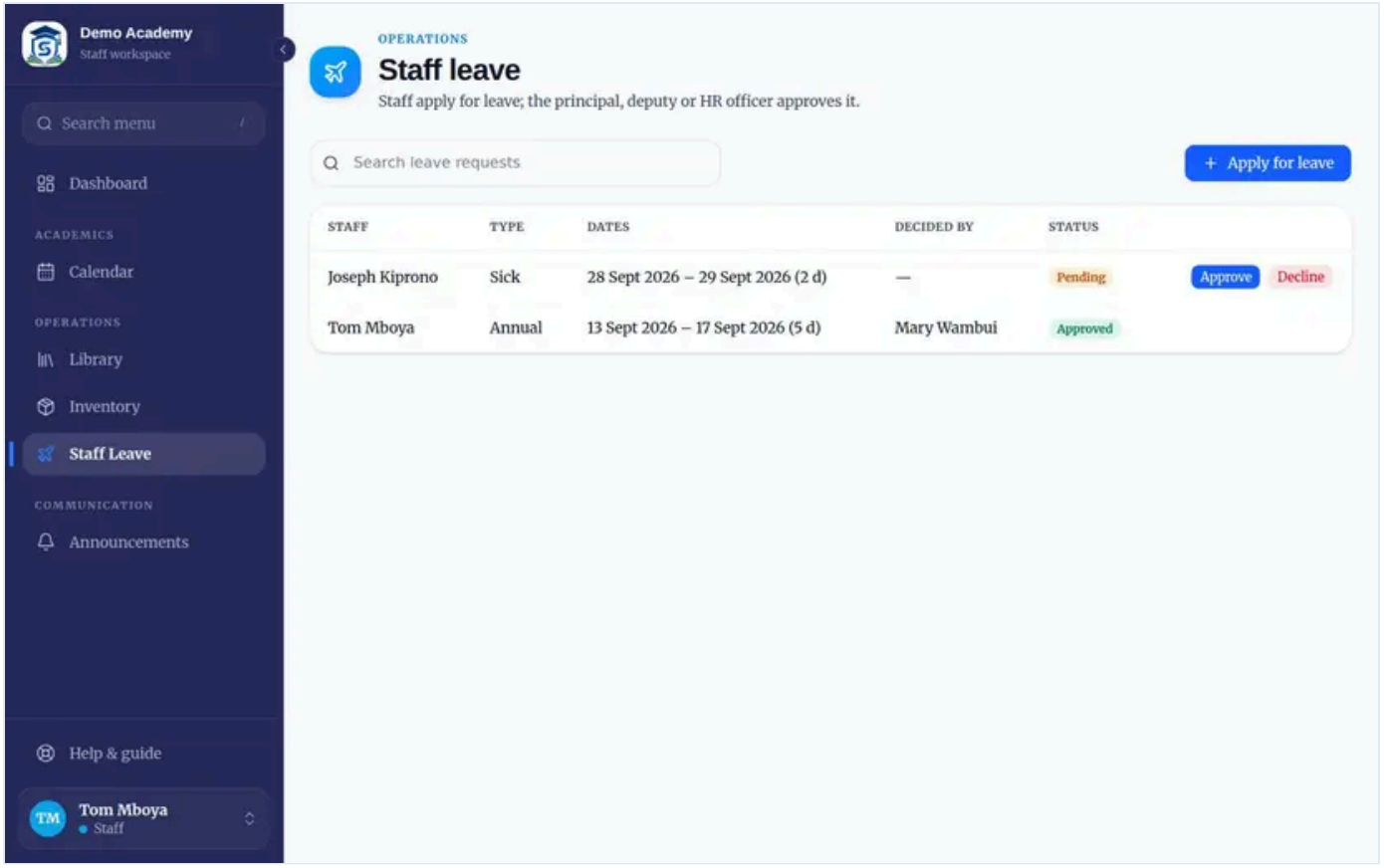
CHAPTER 8

Approvals

The principal and deputy approve staff leave and spending.

8.1 Approve staff leave

Staff Leave lists every request with the dates and who will cover. Press Approve or Decline; the teacher sees the decision straight away.



Staff leave: your requests and their status. Approvers see Approve and Decline buttons.

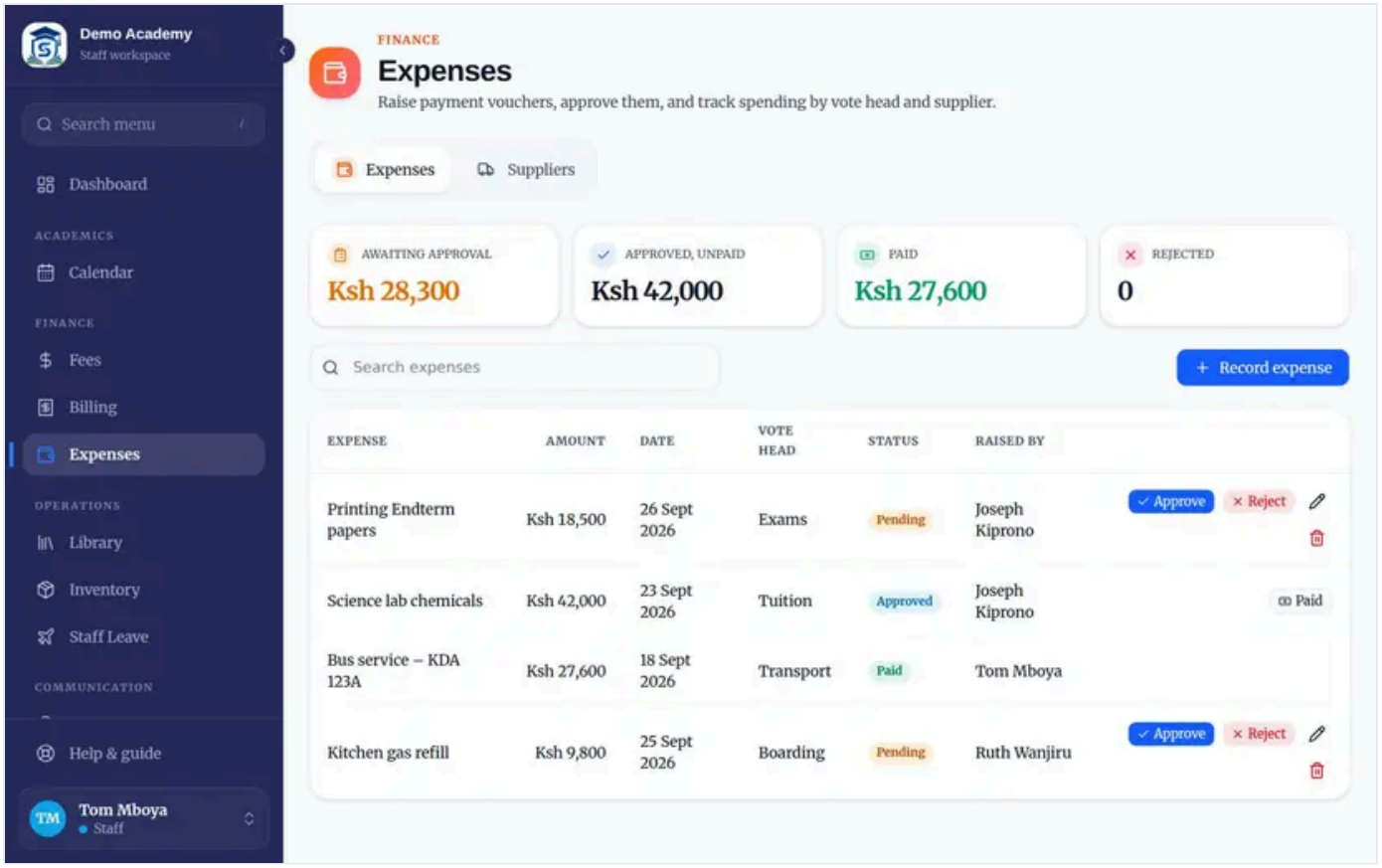
1. **Apply**
   Press “Apply for leave”. Choose the type (annual, sick, maternity, compassionate and so on), the first and last day, and the reason.

2. **Arrange cover**
   Under “Lessons and duties to cover”, say who will take your classes or duties, so the timetabler can arrange cover.

3. **Wait for a decision**
   The request shows Pending until it is approved or declined. You can edit or cancel it while it is pending.

8.2 Approve expenses

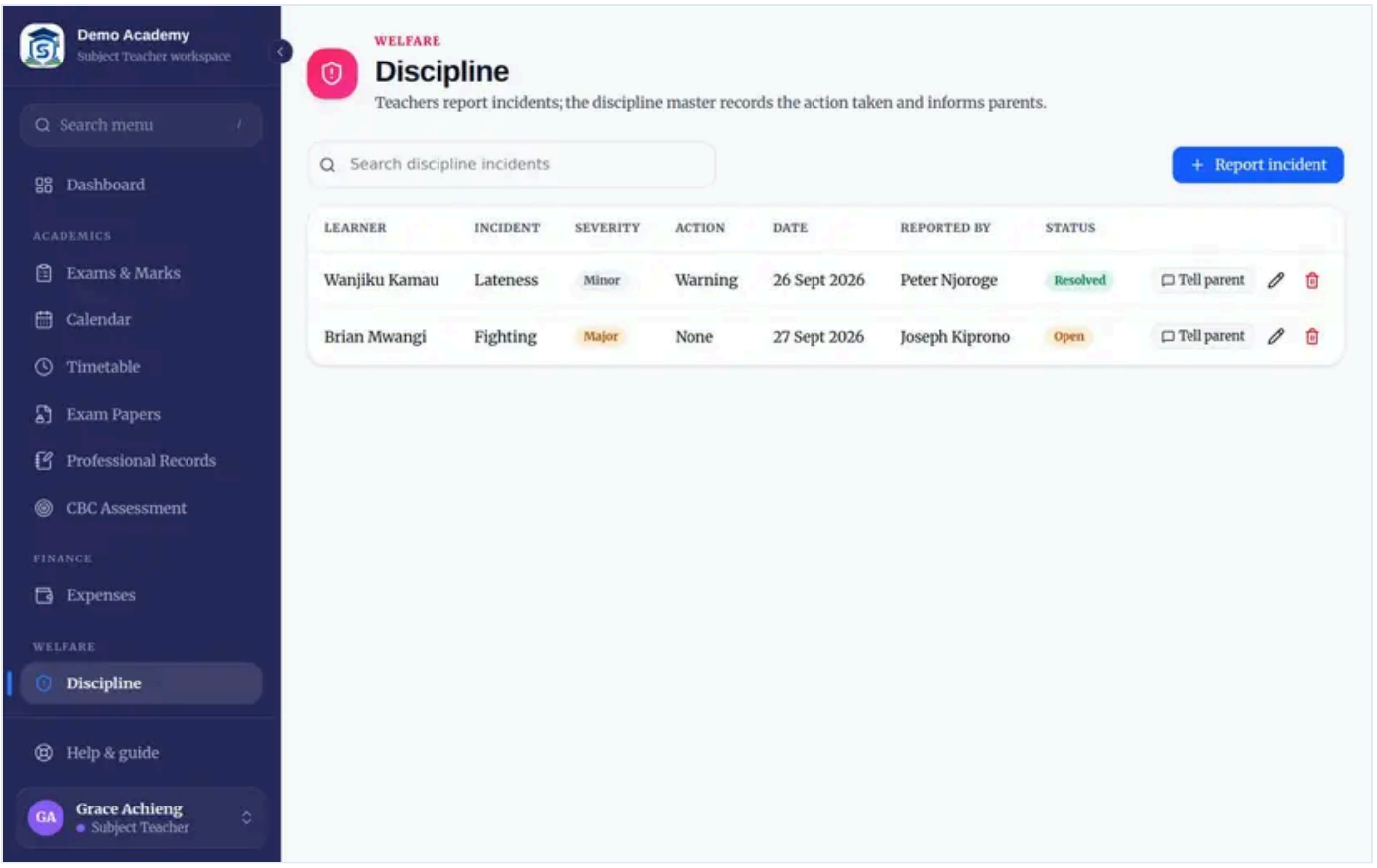
Vouchers raised by staff wait under “Awaiting approval” on Expenses. Approve or reject each one; the bursar then pays approved vouchers and records the payment.



Expenses: approve or reject each voucher.

8.3 Report a discipline incident

Any teacher can report an incident on the Discipline page. You see the incidents you reported; the discipline master decides the action and tells the parent.



Discipline: each incident with its category, severity, action and status.

1 **Report it**

Press “Report incident”. Choose the learner, the date, the category (for example lateness or fighting), how serious it is (minor, major or critical) and describe what happened.

2 **What happens next**

The discipline master records the action taken (for example a warning, counselling or calling the parent in), marks it resolved, and can text the parent with “Tell parent”.

CHAPTER 9

Getting help

Most questions are answered on the page itself: many pages have a “How to” panel at the bottom. For anything else, these are the places to go.

9.1 Where to get help

This guide is always available from Help in the menu, and as a PDF you can download and print.

- Your school administrator can add or reset accounts, fix classes and subjects, and change school settings.
- For problems with Skulbase itself, use the contact page at skulbase.com/contact, or call 0740 129 444.
- When you report a problem, say which page you were on, what you pressed and what you expected. A screenshot helps.